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April 27, 2026

Police Have Reportedly Used License Plate Readers to Stalk Romantic Interests

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This article was updated on September 3, 2026. For a more comprehensive and up-to-date tally of ALPR abuse, check out IJ's [database of ALPR abuse](#).

Across the United States, communities are [rethinking their use](#) of Flock cameras and other automated license plate reader (ALPR) systems, and in many cases [ending the](#). The proliferation of police surveillance has led to repeated abuse. One shockingly common form: police officers using ALPR camera networks to keep tabs on their romantic interests. An ongoing review of media reports and public records by the Institute for Justice has identified dozens of cases nationwide of officers allegedly abusing ALPR data this year. Flock Safety and other ALPR providers emphasize that they have internal safeguards to prevent this kind of misuse. But only a few of the dozens of analyzed cases were “The fundamental problem with these systems is that they place private information about people’s movements over time in the hands of every officer,” said [Michael Soyars](#). In March, for instance, an officer [resigned from the Milwaukee Police Department](#) after allegedly using the department’s network of ALPRs to track his romantic partner. Several other Wisconsin officers have also been accused of Flock stalking in the past year. In Menasha, an officer was [placed on leave and charged with misconduct in office](#). In at least one instance, an officer used an ALPR system to stalk a stranger they wanted to pursue romantically. Earlier this year in Florida, a Monroe County sheriff’s deputy

The dozens of cases listed below are almost certainly an undercount. Not all police misconduct gets detected, and some cases likely get resolved quietly. Officers frequer

The list also excludes ALPR abuse that doesn't conclusively involve romantic partners.

Last year the Institute for Justice launched the [Plate Privacy Project](#), a joint effort to push back against warrantless mass surveillance through litigation, legislation, activi

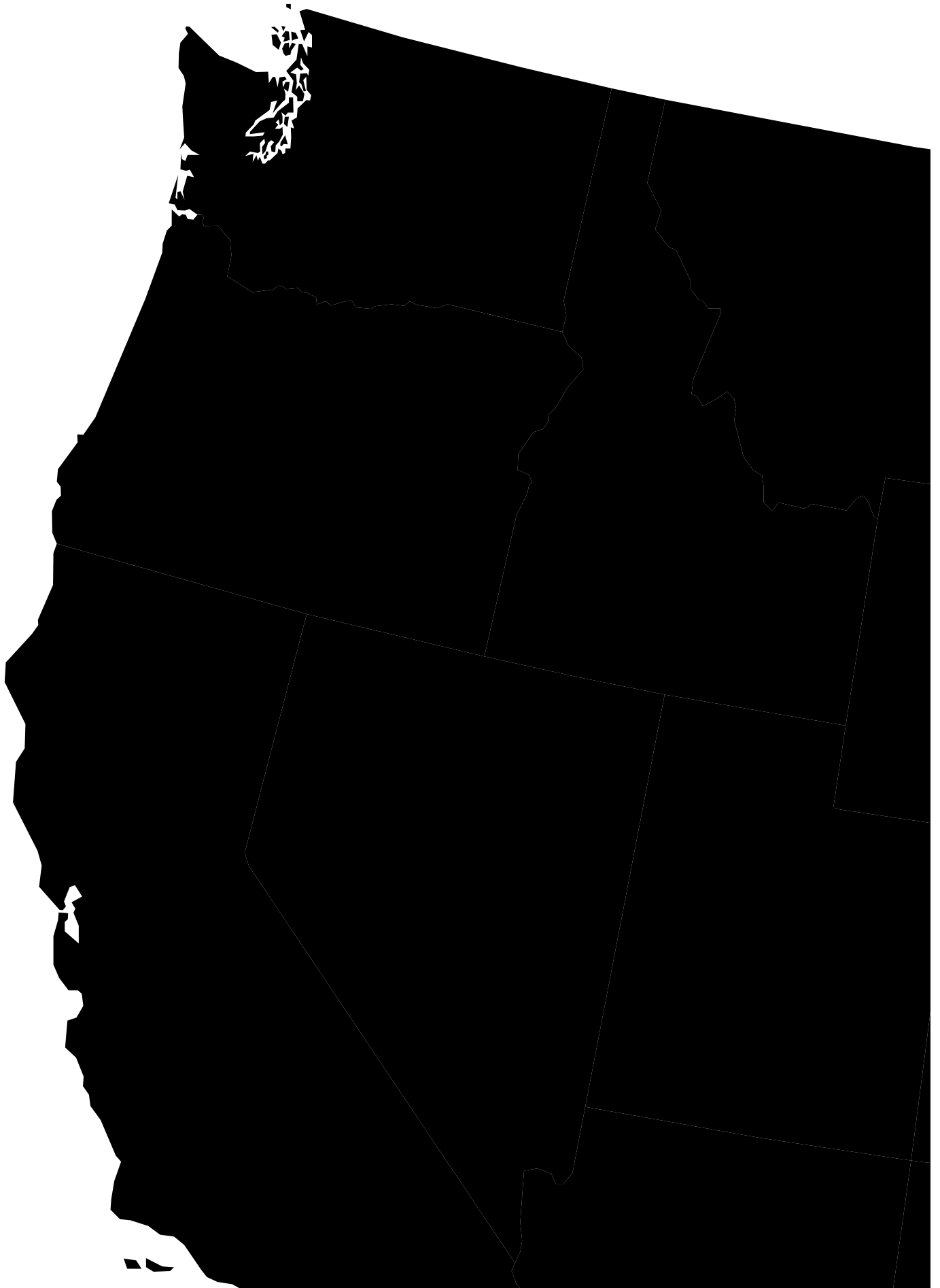
List of known ALPR romantic stalking cases

66 incidents shown

+

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Reset





San Jose, California	New Bedford, Massachusetts	Richmond County, Georgia	Colleton County, South Carolina	Habersham County, Georgia	Creve Coeur, Illinois	Br	
Alpharetta, Georgia	Gwinnett County, Georgia	Conyers, Georgia	Mauldin, South Carolina	Key West, Florida	Kingsville, Texas	Shively, Kentucky	Reynoldsburg, Ohi
Matteson, Illinois	Haines City, Florida	Shelby County, Tennessee	Braselton, Georgia	Riverside County, California	Orange City, Florida	Stow, Massachusetts	Dallas,
Incident List							

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